



Zoo Explorers

Meet the Fishing Cat!

Vulnerable

Facts • Colour • Activities

Fishing Cat Fact File ■

Scientific name:	Prionailurus viverrinus
Status:	Vulnerable
Where they live:	India, Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, Nepal, Thailand, Cambodia, Vietnam, Sumatra
Habitat:	Wetlands, mangroves, marshes, and riverbanks of South and Southeast Asia
Diet:	Carnivore — primarily fish (dives underwater to catch them), plus frogs, snakes, and lizards
Weight:	5–16 kg
Lifespan:	10–12 years in the wild
Population:	Fewer than 10,000 estimated

Amazing Facts ■

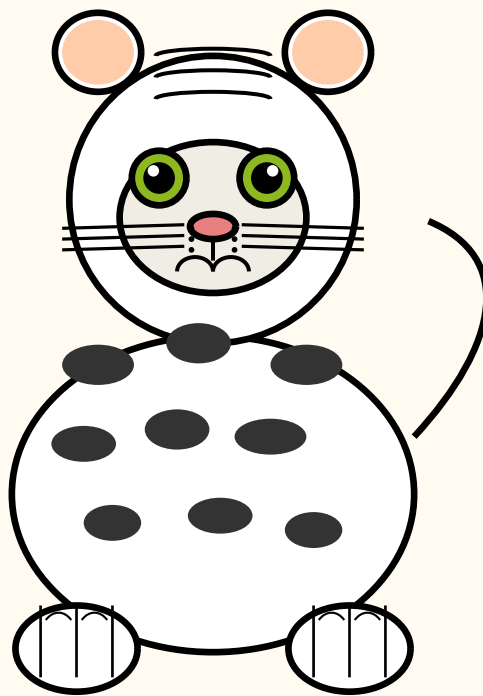
- The fishing cat is one of the few wild cats that dives into water to catch fish.
- Its paws are partially webbed — a special adaptation for swimming and hunting.
- Fishing cats tap the water surface with a paw to mimic insects, luring fish up.
- They have two fur layers: a dense waterproof undercoat and longer spotted guard hairs.
- Despite being about twice the size of a domestic cat, they can tackle prey as large as dogs.
- Fishing cats can swim several kilometres between wetland patches.

Threats ■■

#	Threat	Impact
1	Wetland destruction — over 50% of Asia's wetlands lost since 1970	CRITICAL
2	Overfishing depleting prey in waterways	HIGH
3	Hunting and trapping	HIGH
4	Pollution of rivers and wetlands	MODERATE

Colour Me! — Fishing Cat

Fishing cats have olive-grey fur with rows of solid dark spots and short stripes running along their neck and back.



Activities

Word Search — find all 8 words!

S	W	I	M	M	E	R	B	U	W	Z	M
L	X	V	N	O	E	Y	A	I	F	L	C
K	B	T	Q	K	N	F	M	C	M	W	H
S	Z	N	P	J	D	V	A	D	A	C	Z
V	E	J	R	X	A	Z	E	E	N	C	S
W	P	J	E	P	N	R	E	Y	G	W	W
E	T	F	D	V	G	C	P	I	R	V	E
T	C	I	A	O	E	I	C	G	O	P	B
L	W	F	T	A	R	N	L	N	V	M	B
A	H	O	O	S	E	S	H	I	E	R	E
N	L	G	R	I	D	W	G	H	P	A	D
D	J	P	O	A	F	I	S	H	I	N	G

FISHING	WETLAND	PREDATOR	ENDANGERED
ASIA	WEBBED	MANGROVE	SWIMMER

Match It Up!

Fishing Cat		protecting the cat and its habitat
Wetland		coastal forest in saltwater
Webbed paws		help the cat swim
Mangrove		watery home of the fishing cat
Conservation		wild cat that dives for fish

Fill in the Blanks!

- The fishing cat lives in _____ and marshy areas of Asia.
- Its paws are partially _____ for swimming.
- Asia has lost over _____ of its wetlands since 1970.
- Fishing cats lure fish by _____ the water surface.

Answers: wetlands | webbed | 50% | tapping

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